Unit 6 · Comparatives and superlatives: long adjectives and irregular

Name _____

THE BIG IDEA

For long adjectives we use more / less + than for two things and the most / the least for the winner. Good and bad are irregular.

Длинные прилагательные: more / less ... than (двое), the most / the least (самый). Good и bad — особые.

How we build it

WHICH	PATTERN	EXAMPLE	РУССКИЙ
Compare 2	more / less · adjective · than	**This bed is more comfortable than that one.**	Эта кровать удобнее.
Number 1	the most / the least · adjective	**It's the most expensive bed.**	Это самая дорогая кровать.
-y words	-ier / the -iest	**happy → happier → the happiest**	
good	good → better → the best	**My old bed is the best.**	Моя старая кровать лучшая.
bad	bad → worse → the worst	**Wednesday was the worst.**	Среда была самой плохой.

When we use it

Compare two things: A metal bed is harder than a wooden bed.
Сравнить два предмета.

Choose the best: This is the most modern bed.
Выбрать лучшее.

Tell about a bad day: Tuesday was worse.
Сказать о плохом дне.

REMEMBER

than → comparative (comparing 2). the ... in the store / of all → superlative (3 or more).

RUSSIAN AND ENGLISH

In Russian one word can do it («удобнее»). In English long adjectives need MORE / LESS or THE MOST / THE LEAST. Never both: not 'more bigger'.

Watch out! We often say...

~~This bed is more good.~~	**This bed is better.**
~~It is the most cheapest bed.~~	**It's the cheapest bed.**
~~My bed is comfortabler.~~	**My bed is more comfortable.**
~~This is the worse bed.~~	**This is the worst bed.**

EASY TRICK

Short word → -er / -est. Long word → more / the most. NEVER both (not 'more bigger', not 'the most cheapest').

Try it! Circle the right answer

1 It's ___ than that one. (more comfortable / comfortabler)

2 The ___ bed in the store. (most expensive / expensivest)

3 My old bed is ___. (the best / the goodest)

4 Tuesday was ___ than Monday. (worse / badder)

5 happy → ___

6 It's ___ expensive. (less / lesser)

Answers: 1 more comfortable · 2 most expensive · 3 the best · 4 worse · 5 happier · 6 less